Faculty of Native Studies
University of Alberta

Native Studies 201 – LEC 851 (86983)
Indigenous | Canada: Looking Forward, Looking Back
Winter 2026

Instructor: Dr. Katie Pollock
Email: kcpolloc@ualberta.ca

Office Hours: *by appointment only*

Class Times: Asynchronous
Class Location: Canvas

FNS Front Office No: 780-492-2991
or nativestudies@ualberta.ca

The Native Studies Front desk on the second floor in Pembina Hall is open 8:30-12:00 and 13:00-16:30.

Please note: if you have technical issues or questions about the Canvas environment, please contact Information Services and Technology (IST): https://www.ualberta.ca/information-services-and-technology/self-service/contact- us.html

PREAMBLE

"The course outline acts as an understanding between the student and the instructor regarding details of the course. Modifications to this understanding may be made with fair warning and general class consent." Course Requirements, Evaluation Procedures and Grading Section of the University Calendar Sec. 61.6 GFC

"Policy about course outlines can be found in Course Requirements, Evaluation Procedures and Grading Section of the University Calendar Sec. 61.6 GFC

In this asynchronous online course, you will move through the course material and activities at the same pace as the rest of the class. **There are no real-time virtual classroom sessions to attend.** This provides some flexibility for when you would like to engage with the course materials and online activities.

COURSE CALENDAR DESCRIPTION

This course is designed for students from faculties outside the Faculty of Native Studies with an interest in acquiring a basic familiarity with Indigenous/non-Indigenous relationships. While the NS 201 instructors may vary from term to term, the online pre-developed material will remain the same every term. Consists of a survey of historical and contemporary relationships between Indigenous peoples and newcomers, with the aim of expanding the understandings held by many Canadians about these relationships. This course will be delivered online. Not open to students with credit in NS 200. Not designed for Native Studies majors.

COURSE OBJECTIVES

The purpose of this course is for students to:

- Examine historical experiences and contemporary lives, identities, cultural expressions, rights, and goals of Indigenous peoples.
- Address a growing practical attention and curiosity-driven concern by industry, government and the public to comprehend Indigenous knowledge and experiences so as to better interact with the growing Canadian Indigenous population.
- Present new ways of understanding relations between Indigenous peoples and the larger society to promote deep respect for the knowledge and traditions of Canada's First Peoples and their place in contemporary Canada.
- Reveal what are we missing when we neglect the interconnections between Indigenous and settler communities.

REQUIRED TEXTS

- Course materials are supplied as PDFs (portable document format), or as links within Canvas, the University of Alberta's online learning management system. Required course materials include videos, course notes, and articles.
- Optional readings will also be provided within Canvas. See detailed course schedule below.
- Please read the course syllabus CAREFULLY clicking on hyperlinks to access extra materials or to jump to different content in this document.

STATEMENT OF EXPECTATIONS

In this course, our primary focus is to cultivate an equitable, inclusive, and accessible learning community that emphasizes individual critical thinking and problem-solving skills. To ensure a fair and consistent learning experience for all students, the use of advanced AI tools such as ChatGPT or Dall-E 2 is strictly prohibited for all academic (written/coding/creative/etc.) work, assignments, and assessments in this course. Each student is expected to complete all tasks without substantive assistance from others, including AI tools.

WEEKLY SCHEDULE AND READINGS

There is no assigned textbook for this class. Instead, each week's readings are provided to you on our Canvas Class Homepage under 'Modules.'

MODULE NAME	DATE	READING
Module 1: Worldview	Week 1: Jan 5-9, 2026	Braiding Sweetgrass, pp. 14-16 Vowel, Chapter 1, pp. 7-13 Vowel, Chapter 2, pp. 14-22
Module 2: "Fur Trade"	Week 2: Jan 12-16, 2026	Vowel, Chapter 6, pp. 60-66 Gaudy, "Fantasies," pp. 46-74
Module 3: "Trick or Treaty"	Week 3: Jan 19-23, 2026	Mitchell, "Migwite'tmeg," pp. 193-218 Starblanket, "Crisis," pp. 13-33
Module 4: "New Rules, New Games"	Week 4: Jan 26-30, 2026	Vowel, Chapter 26, pp. 235-242 Crosschild, "Awakening," pp. 5-29
FIRST EXAM (30%) – WEEK 5: FEBRUARY 2 TO 6		
Module 5: "Killing the Indian in the Child"	Week 6: Feb 9-13, 2026	Akiwenzie-Dsamm, "Nimkii," pp. 138-164 TRC, "Calls to Action," pp. 1-15 Jewel & Mosby, "Calls to Accountability," pp. 1-24
READING WEEK – WEEK 7: FEBRUARY 16-20, 2026		
Module 6: "A Modern Indian?"	Week 8: Feb 23-27, 2026	Jobin, "Upholding," pp. 22-40 Peggy, "This Place," pp. 1-28
Module 7: "Red Power"	Week 9: Mar 2-6, 2026	Sinclair & Lodwick, "Warrior Nation," pp. 221-246 Simpson, "Lands as Pedagogy," pp. 1-25
Module 8: "Sovereign Lands"	Week 10: Mar 9-13, 2026	Kimmer, "Maple Nation," pp. 167-174 Moreton-Robinson, "Incommensurable," pp. 257-268
SECOND EXAM (30%) – WEEK 11: MAR 16-20, 2026		
Module 9: "Indigenous Women, Girls, and Genderful People"	Week 12: March 23-27, 2026	Simpson, "Centring," pp. 215-239 Anderson et al., "Sitting," pp. 305-326
Module 10: "Indigenous in the City" & Module 11: "Current Social Movements"	Week 13: Mar 30-Apr 3, 2026	Thrush, Chapter 12, pp. 110-117 Wilson & Zheng, Chapter 1, pp. 14-31 Hill, "The 500," pp. 125-133
Module 12: "'Living' Traditions – Expressions in Pop Culture/Art"	Week 14: April 6-10, 2026	Vowel, "kitaskînaw 2350," pp. 246-276 Foster & Evans, "Decolonizing," pp. 275-283
THIRD EXAM (40%) – WEEK 15: APRIL 13 TO 17, 2026		

COURSE SCHEDULE (DETAILED READING OVERVIEW)

MODULE 1: WORLDVIEW **WEEK 1: JANUARY 5-9, 2026**

Kimmerer, Robin Wall. "Skywoman Falling." In *Braiding Sweetgrass*, 14–16. Milkweed Editions, 2015.

Vowel, Chelsea. "Just Don't Call Us Late for Supper: Names for Indigenous Peoples." In *Indigenous Writes: A Guide to First Nations, Metis & Inuit Issues in Canada*, Chapter 1, 7–13. Winnipeg, Manitoba: HighWater Press, 2016.

Vowel, Chelsea. "Settling on a Name: Names for Non-Indigenous Canadians." In *Indigenous Writes: A Guide to First Nations, Metis & Inuit Issues in Canada*, Chapter 2, 14–22. Winnipeg, Manitoba: HighWater Press, 2016.

MODULE 2: FUR TRADE **WEEK 2: JANUARY 12-16, 2026**

Vowel, Chelsea. "Hunter-Gatherers or Trapper-Harvesters: Why Some Terms Matter." In *Indigenous Writes: A Guide to First Nations, Metis & Inuit Issues in Canada*, Chapter 6, 60–66. Winnipeg: HighWater Press, 2016.

Gaudry, Adam. "Fantasies of Sovereignty: Deconstructing British and Canadian Claims to Ownership of the Historic North-West." *Native American and Indigenous Studies* 3, no. 1 (2016): 46–74.

MODULE 3: TRICK OR TREATY **WEEK 3: JANUARY 19-23, 2026**

Mitchell, Brandon. "Migwite'tmeg: We Remember." In *This Place: 150 Years Retold*, edited by Alicia Elliott, 193–218. Winnipeg, Manitoba: HighWater Press, 2019.

Starblanket, Gina. "Crisis of Relationship: The Role of Treaties in Contemporary Indigenous-Settler Relations." In *Visions of the Heart: Issues Involving Indigenous Peoples in Canada*, Fifth edition., edited by Gina Starblanket, David Alan Long, and Olive Patricia Dickason, 13–33. Don Mills, Ontario: Oxford University Press, 2020.

MODULE 4: NEW RULES, NEW GAMES **WEEK 4: JANUARY 26-30, 2026**

Vowel, Chelsea. "Rights? What Rights?: Doctrines of Colonialism." In *Indigenous Writes: A Guide to First Nations, Métis & Inuit Issues in Canada*, Chapter 26, 235–42. Winnipeg, Manitoba: HighWater Press, Portage & Main Press, 2016.

Crosschild, Starblanket, Voth, Hubbard, and Bear. "Awakening Buffalo Consciousness." *Wicazo Sa Review* 36, no. 1 (2021): 5–29.

FIRST EXAM (30%) **WEEK 5: FEBRUARY 2-6, 2026**

MODULE 5: "KILLING THE INDIAN IN THE CHILD" **WEEK 6: FEBRUARY 9-13, 2026**

Akiwenzie-Damm, Kateri. "Nimkii." In *This Place: 150 Years Retold*, 3rd ed., 138–64. Winnipeg, Manitoba: HighWater Press, 2019.

Truth and Reconciliation Commission of Canada. *Calls to Action*. Winnipeg: National Centre for Truth and Reconciliation, 2015.

Jewell, Eva, and Ian Mosby. *Calls to Action Accountability: A 2023 Status Update on Reconciliation*. Toronto: Yellowhead Institute, 2023.

READING WEEK **WEEK 7: FEBRUARY 16-20, 2026**

MODULE 6: A MODERN INDIAN? **WEEK 8: FEBRUARY 23-27, 2026**

Jobin, Shalene Wuttunee. "Grounding Economic Relationships." In *Upholding Indigenous Economic Relationships: Nehiyawak Narratives*, 22–40. Vancouver: UBC Press, 2023.

Robertson, David A. "Peggy." In *This Place: 150 Years Retold*, 3rd ed., 83–110. Winnipeg, Manitoba: HighWater Press, 2019.

MODULE 7: RED POWER **WEEK 9: MARCH 2-6. 2026**

Sinclair, Niigaanwewidam James. "Warrior Nation." In *This Place: 150 Years Retold*, 3rd ed., 221–46. Winnipeg, Manitoba: HighWater Press, 2019.

Simpson, Leanne Betasamosake. "Land as Pedagogy: Nishaabeg Intelligence and Rebellious Transformation." *Decolonization: Indigeneity, Education & Society* 3, no. 3 (2014): 1–25.

MODULE 8: SOVEREIGN LANDS **WEEK 10: MARCH 9-13, 2026**

Kimmerer, Robin Wall. "Maple Nation: A Citizenship Guide." In *Braiding Sweetgrass*, 167–74. Milkweed Editions, 2015.

Moreton-Robinson, Aileen. "Incommensurable Sovereignties: Indigenous Ontology Matters." In *Routledge Handbook of Critical Indigenous Studies*, 1st ed., edited by Brendan Hokowhitu, Aileen Moreton-Robinson, Linda Tuhiwai-Smith, Chris Andersen, and Steve Larkin, 257–68. New York, NY: Routledge, 2020.

SECOND EXAM (30%) **WEEK 11: MARCH 16-20, 2026**

MODULE 9: INDIGENOUS WOMEN, GIRLS… WEEK 12: MARCH 23-27, 2026

Simpson, Leanne Betasamosake. "Centring Resurgence Taking on Colonial Gender Violence in Indigenous Nation Building." In *Keetsahnak / Our Missing and Murdered Indigenous Sisters*, edited by Kim Anderson, Maria Campbell, and et. al, 215–39. University of Alberta Press, 2018.

Anderson, Kim, ed. "Epilogue: Sitting in with Sisters." In *Keetsahnak / Our Missing and Murdered Indigenous Sisters*, with Maria Campbell, Christi Belcourt, Tracy Bear, et al., 305–26. University of Alberta Press, 2018.

MODULE 10: INDIGENOUS IN THE CITY & MODULE 11: CURRENT SOCIAL MOVEMENTS WEEK 13: MARCH 30-APRIL 3, 2026

[M10] Thrush, Coll. "Placing the City: Crafting Urban Indigenous Histories." In *Sources and Methods in Indigenous Studies*, edited by Chris Andersen and Jean M. O'Brien, 110–17. Routledge Guides to Using Historical Sources. Abingdon, Oxon New York, NY: Routledge, 2017.

[M11] Wilson, Alex, and Corals Zheng. "Shifting Social Media and the Idle No More Movement." In *Indigenous Peoples Rise up: The Global Ascendency of Social Media Activism*, edited by Bronwyn Carlson and Jeff Berglund, 14–31. Global Media and Race. New Brunswick: Rutgers University Press, 2021.

[M11] Hill, Gord, and Pamela D. Palmater. "Six Nations Land Reclamation. Idle No More, Elsipogtog, #NODAPL, and Unist'ot'en." In *The 500 Years of Indigenous Resistance Comic Book*, Revised and expanded, 125–33. Vancouver: Arsenal Pulp Press, 2023.

MODULE 12: 'LIVING' TRADITIONS WEEK 14: APRIL 6-10, 2026

Vowel, Chelsea. "Kitaskînaw 2350." In *This Place: 150 Years Retold*, 3rd ed., 246–76. Winnipeg, Manitoba: HighWater Press, 2019.

Foster, Stephen, and Mike Evans. "Decolonizing Representation: Ontological Transformations Through Re-Mediation of Indigenous Representation in Popular Culture and Indigenous Interventions." In *The Routledge Companion to Indigenous Art Histories in the United States and Canada*, edited by Heather L. Igloliorte and Carla Taunton, 275–83. Routledge Companions. New York London: Routledge, Taylor & Francis Group, 2023.

THIRD EXAM (40%) WEEK 15: APRIL 13-17, 2026

COURSE REQUIREMENTS/ASSIGNMENTS

Exams will be available to take through the Learning Assessment Centre or Dean of Students Office (for students with approved accommodations). The Learning Assessment Centre (LAC) at the University of Alberta provides secure digital exam services and students can choose to write exams in-person at the LAC computer lab or remotely on Canvas. Exams will be open-book and fully automated. Detailed instructions for each exam, assignment, and evaluation criteria will be posted in Canvas. Note that you may click on each assessment title to link to the detailed description below. Students are strongly encouraged to book their exams as soon as possible.

ASSESSMENT	WEIGHTING	EXAM DATE
First Exam	30%	February 2-6, 2026
Second Exam	30%	March 16-20, 2026
Third Exam	40%	April 13-17, 2026
Total	100%	

EXAM INFORMATION: GENERAL INFORMATION

1. First Exam (30%)
The first exam will encompass the learning and scholarly materials from Module 1: Worldview to Module 4: New Rules, New Games. This includes material from the videos, course readings, and other scholarly material posted on Canvas. This will be an open- book exam that will consist of a combination of multiple choice, mix-and-match, and fill-in the- blank questions. This exam will be a duration of 2 hours and can be completed during the exam week **(February 2-6, 2026).**

2. Second Exam (30%)
The second exam will encompass the learning and scholarly materials from Module 5: "Killing the Indian in the Child" to Module 8: Sovereign Lands. This includes material from the videos, course readings, and other scholarly material posted on Canvas. This will be an open-book exam that will consist of a combination of multiple-choice, mix-and-match, and fill-in the-blank questions. This exam will be a duration of 2 hours and can be completed during the exam week **(March 16-20, 2026).**

3. Third Exam (40%)
The third exam will encompass the learning and scholarly materials from Module 9: Indigenous Women, Girls, and Genderful People to Module 12: 'Living' Traditions – Expressions in Pop Culture/Art. This includes material from the videos, course readings, and other scholarly material posted on Canvas. This will be an open- book exam that will consist of a combination of multiple-choice, mix-and-match, fill-in the blanks, and short answer questions. Additionally, this exam will have a longer short essay component that will ask you to reflect on the cumulative learnings from the course. This exam will be a duration of 3 hours and can be completed during the exam week **(April 13-17, 2026).**

SUBMISSION OF ASSIGNMENTS

All assignment submission deadlines are based on **Mountain Standard Time** (MST) and time coded in 24-hour clock (i.e., 1:00 PM is 13:00). ***There are no written assignments on this course***. Please see the Exam Information section (above) for details on course assessment.

GRADING SYSTEM

4.0	A+	90-100%
4.0	A	85-89%
3.7	A-	80-84%
3.3	B+	77-79%
3.0	B	73-76%
2.7	B-	70-72%
2.3	C+	67-69%
2.0	C	63-66%
1.7	C-	60-62%
1.3	D+	55-59%
1.0	D	50-54%
0.0	F	0-49%

Missed Term Work And Absence From Exams: Please see Calendar Attendance regarding **Absence from Term Work** and **Absence from Exams.**

PASSED OR REPRESENTATIVE EVALUATIVE COURSE MATERIAL

Representative evaluative materials will be explained and some representative questions (three practice exams) in NS201 will be provided via Canvas.

DEFERRED FINAL EXAMINATIONS

Application for a deferral of a Final Exam will require approval of your home Faculty.

"A student must present supporting documentation pertaining to the absence to their Faculty office **within two working days following the scheduled date of the exam missed**, or as soon as the student is able, having regard to the circumstances underlying the absence." https://calendar.ualberta.ca/content.php?catoid=39&navoid=12216#examinations- exams

The **final dates to apply for a deferred Final Exam** in this course will begin on **April 20, 2026, and the end of the day on April 21, 2026 (16:30 pm – 4:30 pm).**

Please note that it is not up to the instructor to permit or deny a deferral of a final exam; only the Dean's Office may do so with supporting documentation and just cause.

University policy, Absence from Final Exams, (23.3(2)e) states that a deferred exam will NOT be approved if a student:

i. has not been in regular attendance where attendance and/or participation is required, and/or,
ii. excluding the final exam, has completed less than half of the assigned work.

Cell Phones: Cell phones are to be turned off during class times. Cell phones are not to be brought to exams. (On class disruptions, see Code of Student Behaviour 30.5.3)

Communication: Electronic communication, most commonly email communication, will be sent to a student's University of Alberta email address. It is students' responsibility to regularly check their email. Three (3) business days are the length of time for a response from an instructor because of other commitments instructors have.

Recording of Lectures: Audio or video recording, digital or otherwise, of lectures, labs, seminars or any other teaching environment by students is allowed only with the prior written consent of the instructor or as a part of an approved accommodation plan. Student or instructor content, digital or otherwise, created and/or used within the context of the course is to be used solely for personal study, and is not to be used or distributed for any other purpose without prior written consent from the content author(s).

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY AND HONESTY

The University of Alberta is committed to the highest standards of academic integrity and honesty. Students are expected to be familiar with these standards regarding academic honesty and to uphold the policies of the University in this respect. as outlined in the Academic Integrity Policy. Students are particularly urged to familiarize themselves with the provisions of the Student *Academic Integrity Policy* and the *Student Conduct Policy* (on the University of Alberta Policies and Procedures Online (UAPPOL) website) and avoid any behaviour which could potentially result in suspicions of cheating, plagiarism, misrepresentation of facts and/or participation in an offence. Academic dishonesty is a serious offence and can result in suspension or expulsion from the University.

Students are expected to become familiar with the Academic Integrity Policy, the Student Academic Integrity Policy Appendix A: Academic Misconduct, Student Academic Integrity Policy, Student Academic Integrity Policy Appendix B: Sanction Descriptions and Impact, Student Academic Misconduct Procedure and Student Academic Misconduct Appeal Procedure.

Students are expected to avoid any behavior Student Academic Integrity Policy Appendix A: Academic Misconduct, which could potentially result in suspicions of plagiarism, examination cheating, contract cheating, unauthorized collaboration, misrepresentation, unauthorized resubmission, misuse of university academic materials or other assets and research and scholarship misconduct, Academic dishonesty is a serious offence and can result in suspension or expulsion from the University. Academic Integrity Policy, the Student Academic Integrity Policy Appendix B: Sanction Descriptions and Impact.

ACADEMIC SUPPORTS

Academic Success Centre, 1-80 Students' Union Building (SUB), 780-492-3381, email: arrec@ualberta.ca provides services to support University of Alberta students in the areas of academic accommodations, writing, and learning. The Academic Success Centre coordinates accommodations and access requests for students who encounter medical and/or non-medical challenges that affect their ability to pursue post-secondary studies. Learn more and apply early. At the Academic Success Centre, students can also access peer-based and professional academic writing support. Writing Services staff are available to work with undergraduate and graduate students at any stage of the writing process. Students can book an appointment to get feedback on a draft to enhance their writing, work on implementing feedback from an instructor or supervisor, or ask about strategies to help address writer's block. In addition to holding appointments, Writing Services staff also offer a range of writing workshops and writing groups. For more information, please visit the Writing Services webpage.

The Learning Strategies area will help students become academically successful. Learning Strategies assists undergraduate and graduate students with time management, scheduling, studying, note-taking, exam preparation, memory strategies, communication and presentation skills. Students can book both 1-1 appointments and group workshops. Students can also attend scheduled drop-in services available in our libraries. If you want more information, visit the Learning Strategies webpage or visit us.

NON-ACADEMIC MISCONDUCT

The Student Conduct Policy describes, in general terms, student behaviours, which if left unchecked would, to an unacceptable degree, disrupt the learning environment, threaten the proper functioning of the University and/or negatively affect the property or reputation of the university, which benefit all members of the University community.

RESEARCH ETHICS BOARD REQUIREMENTS

[Information about ethics required for inclusion in all course outlines where students may choose to conduct interviews or other research with human subjects:

Interviews and community-based knowledge: The Faculty of Native Studies (FNS) encourages students to draw upon community expertise and knowledge and to conduct interviews where appropriate as part of a research process. At the same time, the University of Alberta and FNS require that anyone planning to undertake research with human subjects, including relatives (as opposed to a library or archives-based project), must first submit an ethics proposal and have it approved before conducting any interviews or other research. Papers that violate this requirement will not be accepted, and students could be subject to disciplinary action. ALL applications will need to be prepared in ARISE (https://www.ualberta.ca/research/research-support/research-ethics-office/support/getting-started.html). With the ARISE system, the instructor applies for Ethics for the class and not individual students (so please, contact your instructor). Only proposals that are considered low risk will be reviewed for undergraduate courses.
IMPORTANT: Students may NOT conduct research with human subjects in NS 201.